

A quick bite

Sometimes a snack or a sweet becomes a hit all over the world. It is almost impossible to predict what will be a success, but inventors can grow rich by making the right judgment about the tastes of the public. However, unless they patent their ideas or (as with Coca-Cola), keep the recipe a closely guarded secret, they may find that rivals beat them to the fame and fortune.

Iced desserts

- **What?** Ice cream
- **Who?** Unknown
- **Where and when?** Possibly China, c. 200 BCE

The origins of ice cream are unclear. Many ancient cultures—including the Greeks, the Romans, and the Chinese—enjoyed desserts cooled with snow. Recipes for what is now recognized as ice cream

were first served to European royalty in the 17th century, and gradually spread to the general public.

▼ ICE CREAM VANS

Two young boys enjoy ice cream cones in Hull, UK, in 1961. Traveling ice cream vans are common in many countries.



Modern Fry's chocolate bar

Chocolate delights

- **What?** Solid chocolate bar
- **Who?** Francis Fry
- **Where and when?** UK, 1847

The first people to consume chocolate were the Mayans of Mexico in the 1st millennium CE. They made a bitter drink called *xocolatl* using cocoa beans and spices. In the 16th century, Spanish invaders sweetened the drink with sugar. But it would take until 1847 for the first solid chocolate bar to be produced. It was the creation of a British confectioner, who mixed cocoa powder, cocoa butter, and sugar.

